The big thing today was a meeting with Tip, Howard Bohling, Jim Wright, Jim Baker, Ed Meese, Don Regan and Dave Stockman. The result of my call to Tip. The "gang of 17" had come fairly close together on the budget and revenue package. Their combination of cuts and revenue increases came to $60 billion on the R. side and $35 billion on the D. side. It should have been straight haggling especially since our original budget package called for $101 billion. I didn't try to start bargaining from that figure but started at the $60 billion. Three hours later we'd gotten nowhere. Finally I said I'll split the difference with you and they refused that. Meeting over.

April 29

. . . upstairs to write the speech for tonight's TV broadcast. Got it finished about 5 p.m. Went on at 8 p.m. I hope it gets results . . .

April 30

After the broadcast last night phone calls and wires to W.H. broke all previous records. By 3 p.m., telegrams were 2,723 for 373 against; phone calls, 4,745 for, 1103 against. Met with some of our members of the Gang of 17; they are going to begin putting a budget together in committee.

May 4

. . . [a poll indicated] my speech was to a smaller TV audience than usual; probably due to its last minute nature and no promotion. But people are confused on the whole budget issue and my ratings are way down.

May 5-7

Never got to this journal until today, Friday. Wednesday, things turned up. We got together with